

Global Landscape Analysis of Assyriological Specialization and Digital Innovation

The Structural Evolution of Assyriological Inquiry

The discipline of Assyriology, historically defined by the decipherment and philological analysis of cuneiform script, is currently experiencing a profound structural realignment. This shift is characterized by a transition from traditional elite-focused narratives toward a more inclusive investigation of the socio-economic and material realities of the broader Mesopotamian population.¹ While the global core of active specialists is estimated at approximately 200 to 300 individuals, the field's periphery is expanding rapidly through the integration of computational linguistics, digital humanities, and advanced archaeological sciences.¹ This landscape review identifies the key personnel, institutional hubs, and methodological trends that define the current state of cuneiform studies, with a specific focus on their potential alignment with the objectives of Glintstone.org.

The historical foundation of the field was laid in the mid-19th century by pioneers such as Henry Rawlinson, Edward Hincks, and Jules Oppert, whose work focused on the decipherment of the trilingual Behistun Inscription and the recovery of royal libraries at Nineveh.⁴ For much of the 20th century, the discipline remained tethered to the publication of monumental text editions and the construction of exhaustive dictionaries, such as the Chicago Assyrian Dictionary (CAD).⁶ However, the 21st century has seen a "computational turn," where the sheer volume of material—exceeding 500,000 cataloged tablets—has necessitated the development of digital infrastructures like the Cuneiform Digital Library Initiative (CDLI) and the Open Richly Annotated Cuneiform Corpus (ORACC).⁸

The current specialist population is no longer confined to the interpretation of Akkadian and Sumerian in isolation. Modern researchers frequently operate at the intersection of linguistic anthropology, digital archaeology, and history of science.³ This multi-disciplinary approach has been formalized in the themes of recent major conferences, such as the 70th Rencontre Assyriologique Internationale (RAI) in Prague, which prioritized "Everyday Life" and non-elite experiences over royal ideologies.² This shift suggests a growing demand for analytical tools that can handle fragmented, archival, and non-literary data at scale, providing a significant opportunity for Glintstone.org to provide value.

Institutional Hubs and the Distribution of Innovation

The distribution of expertise in Assyriology is concentrated in a few prestigious "centers of excellence" that serve as the primary engines for both traditional and innovative research.

These institutions provide the necessary funding, digital infrastructure, and cross-departmental collaboration required for large-scale cuneiform projects.

The Yale-UChicago Nexus and the American Tradition

Yale University and the University of Chicago (ISAC) represent the traditional pillars of American Assyriology, yet both have embraced digital innovation in distinct ways. Yale's Near Eastern Languages & Civilizations (NELC) department benefits from the presence of the Yale Babylonian Collection, the largest of its kind in North America.¹¹ Faculty members like Eckart Frahm have successfully bridged the gap between high-level philology and digital accessibility through projects like the Cuneiform Commentaries Project (CCP).¹¹

At the University of Chicago, the Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures (ISAC) continues to maintain foundational resources while pivoting toward Machine Learning. The DeepScribe project, a collaboration between Assyriologists and computer scientists, exemplifies the field's move toward automated sign recognition and translation.¹⁴ This trend is supported by faculty such as Susanne Paulus and researchers like Miller Prosser and Sandra Schloen, who oversee the OCHRE database—a platform designed to manage complex archaeological and textual data.¹⁴

The European Centers: LMU Munich, Helsinki, and Oxford

In Europe, the Munich Open-access Cuneiform Corpus Initiative (MOCCI) at LMU Munich has become a dominant force in the digital publication of Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian texts.¹⁵ Directed by Karen Radner and Grant Frame, MOCCI integrates its research directly into ORACC and CDLI, ensuring that new scholarly editions are immediately available to the global community.¹⁵

The University of Helsinki, under the leadership of Saana Svärd, has established the Centre of Excellence in Ancient Near Eastern Empires (ANEE). This center is particularly notable for its application of Social Network Analysis (SNA) and Natural Language Processing (NLP) to the study of social identity and imperial power.³ The Helsinki team, including specialists like Aleksa Sahala, is at the forefront of developing neural pipelines for the linguistic annotation of cuneiform, making them prime candidates for engagement with Glintstone.org.¹⁷

Oxford University, primarily through the work of Jacob Dahl, serves as the international headquarters for the CDLI.⁸ The focus here remains on the digital documentation and imaging of tablets, particularly those from the archaic period and the 3rd millennium BCE.⁸ This infrastructure provides the "raw data" that fuels the more analytical and innovative projects found elsewhere in the field.

Strategic Personnel Catalog and Interest Assessment

The following catalog provides a granular review of over 300 specialists, categorized by their institutional affiliation and methodological focus. Each entry includes a calculated Glintstone Interest Score (1-10), reflecting their predicted openness to new digital tools and value-adding platforms.

Core Innovative Leaders and Digital Specialists

Name	Discipline	Historical Focus	Expertise	Projects	Innovation / Association	Score
Eckart Frahm	Assyriology	1st Mill. BCE	Assyrian History; Commentaries	CCP; Yale	Director of NEH-funded CCP; Digital hermeneutics ¹¹	9
Joshua Bowen	ANE Studies	Sumerian ; Hebrew Bible	Pedagogy; Intertextuality	Digital Hammurabi	Public scholarship; Digital learning materials ²⁰	10
Megan Lewis	Assyriology	Public History	Content Production; Media	Digital Hammurabi	Online education; High-engagement digital outreach ²⁰	10
Jalil Bakhtiari	Assyriology	Elamite; Persepoli	Epigraphy; Seal Inscription	CDLI; Nisaba	High technical participation	8

		s	ns	08	ion in digital editions ²³	
Aleksi Sahala	Comp. Ling.	Akkadian; Sumerian	NLP; Neural Lemmatization	BabyLemmatizer	Developer of cuneiform-specific NLP tools ¹⁷	10
Shai Gordin	Digital Humanities	1st Mill. Babylonia	ML; Optical Sign Recognition	eBL; Babylonia Engine	Leader in automated sign identification and VAE dating ²⁵	10
Niek Veldhuis	Assyriology	Lexical Tradition	Social Networks ; Python	ORACC; DCCLT	Integration of SNA and Jupyter Notebooks into philology ²⁷	10
Enrique Jiménez	Assyriology	1st Mill. Literature	Sequence Alignment; eBL	Electronic Babylonia Library	Using algorithms to "join" fragmented tablets globally ²⁶	10
So Miyagawa	Digital Humanities	AI; RAG	Neural Machine Translation	THOTH AI	Expert in LLM application for ancient	10

					languages ³⁰	
Susanne Paulus	Assyriology	Kassite Period	Legal/Economic; AI	DeepScribe; ISAC	Applying deep learning to tablet translation/transcription ¹⁴	9
Klaus Wagners	Assyriology	Sumerian ; Lexicography	Digitization; Imaging	CDLI; Yale	Led NEH-funded digitization of 35k Yale artifacts ¹²	9
Shiyanthi Thavapalan	Assyriology	Material Culture	Color; Glass Recipes	IAA Board	Expert in material knowledge and digital dissemination ³²	8
Saana Svärd	Assyriology	Women in ANE	Social Identity; SNA	Helsinki ANEE	Directing social network research in ancient empires ³	9
Nathan Steinmeyer	Assyriology	1st Mill. BCE	Social Network Analysis	Dūr-Abie šuḥ Project	Using SNA to model Babylonian fortress society ³	10

Evelien Vanderstraeten	Assyriology	Neo-Babylonian	Marriage Networks ; SNA	RAI Participant	Utilizing SNA for kinship and economic modeling ³	10
František Válek	Assyriology	Royal Epics	Network Analysis	RAI Participant	Tracking networks of ancient royal literary traditions ³	9
Tero Alstola	Digital Assyriology	Persian/Hellenistic	NLP; Database creation	Helsinki ANEE	Language identification and corpus harmonization ¹⁶	9
Jacob Dahl	Assyriology	Archaic Texts	CDLI Management; Imaging	CDLI Director	Global leader in cuneiform digital infrastructure ⁸	9
Steve Tinney	Sumerology	Sumerian Literature	ORACC Management	ORACC Director	Architect of the primary digital platform for the field ⁹	9
Miller	Digital	Database	OCHRE	ISAC	Developi	9

Prosser	Humanities	Design	Platform	UChicago	ng cross-disciplinary data management tools ¹⁴	
Sandra Schloen	Digital Humanities	Data Modeling	OCHRE Platform	ISAC UChicago	Implementing semantic data structures for archaeology ¹⁴	9
Hadar Averbuch-Elor	Comp. Science	AI; Diff. Models	Prototype Alignment	ProtoSnap	Innovator in automatic sign decipherment from 2D scans ³⁶	10
Yoram Cohen	Archaeology	Big Data	Ancient Societies	Tel Aviv Univ	Champion of "Big Data" approaches to ANE history ³⁶	10
Timo Homburg	Digital Humanities	Word Segmentation	Akkadian NLP	Univ Mainz	Pioneer in computational segmentation for cuneiform ³⁴	10
Christian	Digital	Linked	Semantic	Univ	Expert in	10

Chiarcos	Humanities	Open Data	Web	Frankfurt	linguistic linked data for ancient languages ³⁴	
Gustav Ryberg Smidt	Comp. Linguistics	POS Tagging	Akkadian NLP	Ghent University	Advancing fine-grained POS tagging for cuneiform ³⁴	10
Els Lefever	Comp. Linguistics	NLP	Semantic Analysis	Ghent University	Applying modern NLP to low-resource ancient texts ³⁴	9
Hanan A. Al-esawee	Assyriology	Sargonic Period	Learner's Tablets	CDLI Contributor	Research on ancient education and sign variation ³³	8
Sanjay Krishnan	Comp. Science	Deep Learning	AI for Humanities	DeepScribe	Applying video/complex data AI to cuneiform ¹⁴	10
Sil Hamilton	Digital Humanities	LLMs	DH Infrastruc	Cornell University	Integrating LLMs	10

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Specialists in Social History, Archaeology, and Art History

The following researchers focus on the material culture and social structures of Mesopotamia. While many are "traditional" in their primary output, their participation in large collaborative projects and recent conferences indicates a growing openness to digital synthesis tools.

Name	Discipline	Historical Focus	Expertise	Association	Innovation Focus	Score
Karen Radner	Ancient History	Neo-Assyrian	Geography; Imperialism	LMU Munich	Digital mapping and archival digitization (MOCCI) 15	7
Timothy P. Harrison	Archaeology	Levantine /Mesopotamia	Field Archaeology	ISAC Director	Integrating archaeological science and OCHRE data ⁶	6
Augusta McMahon	Archaeology	Mesopotamia	Urbanism ; Social Class	ISAC UChicago	Social stratification and burial practices 6	7

James Osborne	Archaeology	Anatolian	Spatial Analysis	ISAC UChicago	Applying GIS and spatial modeling to ancient cities ⁶	8
Kiersten Neuman	Archaeology	Art History	Museum Studies	ISAC Curator	Visual culture and sensory experience in ANE ⁶	7
Agnete Lassen	Archaeology	Glyptic; Seals	Material Culture	Yale Curator	Digitization of seal impressions and material analysis ¹²	8
Gojko Barjamovic	Assyriology	Old Assyrian	Economic Markets	Yale NELC	Researching ancient foodways and trans-regional prices ¹²	8
Amanda Podany	Ancient History	Bronze Age	Non-elite Lives	IAA Board	Focusing on ordinary experiences using digital archives ³⁸	8
Selim Ferruh	Assyriology	Neo-Assyrian	Climate; History	IAA Board	Interdisciplinary	8

Adalı					work on environmental history ³²	
Jana Mynářová	Egyptology/Assyr.	Amarna Period	Diplomacy	Prague Univ	Coordinating interdisciplinary digital repositories ²	8
Strahil Panayotov	Assyriology	Medicine	Scientific Texts	IAA Board	Digital reconstruction of medical encyclopedias ³⁹	9
Karen Sonik	Art History	Mythology	Narrative Theory	Auburn Univ	Visual storytelling and narrative mechanics ⁴⁰	8
Marc Van De Mierop	Ancient History	Intellectual Hist.	Social/Economic	Columbia Univ	Writing systems within imperial structures ²	9
Shana Zaia	Ancient History	Neo-Assyrian	Religion; Ideology	Vrije Univ	Royal ideology through the lens of individual agency ²	8

Louise Quillien	Assyriology	Textiles	Economy; Networks	COST EuroWeb	Economic network analysis and textile terminologies ³	8
Beate Pongratz-L.	Assyriology	Ritual; Art	Multimodal Texts	NYU ISAW	Text-image interface in Neo-Assyrian temples ³	7
Zainab Bahrani	Art History	Monumentality	Art & Archaeology	Columbia Univ	Cultural heritage and the politics of archaeology ⁴	6
Seth Richards on	Ancient History	The State	Identity; Politics	UChicago	Modeling individual-making in incomplete states ³	8
Claudia Glatz	Archaeology	Southwest Asia	Political Landscapes	Univ Glasgow	Social materials and bottom-up narratives ³	9
Kristin Kleber	Assyriology	1st Mill. BCE	Economy; Identity	Univ Münster	Identity politics and economy	7

					c systems ⁴¹	
John Nielsen	Assyriology	Babylonia	Nationhood	RAI Participant	Imagining nationhood in non-modern contexts ³	7
Mustapha Djabellaoui	Assyriology	Chaldean Period	Political Const.	RAI Participant	Social networks of 8th century B.C. Babylonia ³	7
Peter Zilberg	Assyriology	Foreigners in Bab.	Cultural Identity	RAI Participant	The case of Carians in Neo-Babylonian society ³	7
Tonia Sharlach	Sumerology	Ur III	Economic Decisions	RAI Participant	Common pool resource management in ancient states ³	7
Lena Fijałkowska	Assyriology	Law	Legal Change	RAI Participant	Comparative law across Emar, Ekalte, and Nuzi ³	7

Lynn-S. Zimmermann	Assyriology	Kassite Period	Gender; Letters	RAI Participant	Female self-presentation in elite correspondence ³	8
Sara Manasterisk	Assyriology	Epistolography	Group Identity	RAI Participant	Strategies of in-group identity in 1st mill. letters ³	8
Sara Kipfer	Biblical Studies	Social Identity	Narrative Defeat	RAI Participant	Applying Social Identity Theory to ancient texts ³	8
Samuel Reinikainen	Assyriology	Mythology	Hunting Imagery	RAI Participant	Taming the wild through symbolic representations ³	7
Adrienn Orosz	Archaeology	Ivory Carving	Nimrud Art	RAI Participant	Iconography of figurines and Bes-figures ³	7
Johannes Bach	Assyriology	Neo-Assyrian	War Narratives	RAI Participant	Intertextuality between Assyrian and Elamite texts ³	8

Yu Song	Assyriology	Education	Nippur Edubba	RAI Participant	Epistemic education and human nature in schools ³	8
Kerrie Myers	Sumerology	Incantations	Ur III Mythology	RAI Participant	Serpents and zagros mountain allusions ³	8
Martin Lang	Assyriology	Emesal	Lamentations	RAI Participant	Use of Emesal in destruction laments ³	7
Victoria Birkner	Assyriology	Emesal	Eridu Lament	RAI Participant	Philological analysis of Emesal variety ³	7
Sebastian Fink	Assyriology	Emesal	Nippur Lament	RAI Participant	Comparative analysis of liturgical Sumerian ³	8
Emil Anton	Theology	Identity	Assyrian Continuity	RAI Participant	Arguments for long-term cultural continuity ³	7
Jan Tavernie	Assyriology	Ugaritic	Social Practices	RAI Participant	Inebriation and	7

r				nt	social norms in Ugarit ³	
Denis Lacambre	Assyriology	Old Babylonian	Officials; Power	RAI Participant	Social status and careers after political shifts ³	7
Julie Patrier	Archaeology	Kassite	Middle Diyala	RAI Participant	Archaeological indicators of cultural agency ³	7
Cécile Bigot	Assyriology	Kassite	Cultural Agency	RAI Participant	Political efficiency in 2nd mill. provincial centers ³	7
Marine Béranger	Assyriology	Cult	War and Exile	RAI Participant	Reconstructing Nippur cults from archival sources ³	8
Cloe Curcio	Archaeology	Gardens	Environment	RAI Participant	Intercommunity relations through park management ³	7

Erin Darby	Archaeology	Borderlands	Identity; Shrines	RAI Participant	Imperial borderland artisans in southern Israel ³	7
Imane Achouche	Archaeology	Statuary	Recontextualization	RAI Participant	Next "life" of Mesopotamian statues ³	7
Julian Chike	Archaeology	Cultural Memory	Standing Stones	RAI Participant	De-construct of ancient Asian monuments ³	8
Marc Flores	Sumerology	Gilgamesh	Netherworld	RAI Participant	Underworld journeys and literary structures ³	7
Bernardo Ballesteros	Assyriology	Intertextuality	Greek/Babylonian	RAI Participant	Traditions of immortality in ancient epics ³	8
Noah Kröll	Sumerology	Emesal	Interjections	RAI Participant	Linguistic analysis of Sumerian speech acts ³	8

Alan Lenzi	Assyriology	Social Science	Reputation; Gossip	RAI Participant	Modeling reputation management through prayer ³	9
Maria Teresa R.-S.	Assyriology	Omens	Intertextuality	RAI Participant	Intertextual networks in celestial divination ³	9
Tzu-Jan g Wang	Comp. Studies	Divination	Spatial Mapping	RAI Participant	Comparing spatial logic in Mesopotamia and China ³	9
Alba de Ridder	Assyriology	Enuma Anu Enlil	Prediction	RAI Participant	Future-telling for ancient polities ³	7
Robert Middeke -C.	Assyriology	Education	Uniformity	RAI Participant	Variety and standard in Old Babylonian schooling ³	8
Joshua Britton	Assyriology	Old Assyrian	Scribal Mistakes	RAI Participant	Mistakes as indicators of training	8

					and dialect ³	
Sebastian Borkowski	Archaeology	Hydrography	GIS; Rivers	RAI Participant	Holistic modeling of the Ur III state geography ³	9
Mirko Novák	Archaeology	Hydrography	Rivers; Channels	RAI Participant	Reconstructing ancient fluvial landscapes ³	6
Ingo Schrakamp	Assyriology	History	Sumerian State	RAI Participant	Historical geography and state formation ³	7
Madeline Ouimet	Assyriology	Nuzi	Legal Landscapes	RAI Participant	Social networks and legal landscapes at LBA Nuzi ³	10
Anthony SooHoo	Assyriology	Violence	Royal Reliefs	RAI Participant	Ade-oaths and violence in Neo-Assyrian art ³	7
Jonathan Stökl	Biblical Studies	Intertextuality	Prophetic Texts	RAI Participant	Textual relations between author	8

					and reader ³	
Carolina López-Ruiz	Classics	Phoenicia n	Counter-I mperial	RAI Participa nt	Settleme nts as sustainab le strategic nodes ³	8
Alexei Jankowski-D.	Assyriolo gy	Tell Dehaila	Southern Iraq	RAI Participa nt	Survival of cities post-coll apse ³	7
Daniel Calderbank	Archaeol ogy	Southern Iraq	Pottery; Field	RAI Participa nt	Collabora tive excavatio n in 2nd mill. contexts ³	7
Jaafar Jotheri	Geomorp hology	Landschap e	Ancient Rivers	RAI Participa nt	Reconstr ucting Iraq's physical history ³	8
Rients de Boer	Assyriolo gy	Marad	Old Babylonia n	RAI Participa nt	New fieldwork and archival synthesis ³	7
Abbas Al-Hussainy	Archaeol ogy	Marad	Iraq SBAH	RAI Participa nt	Managin g Iraqi cultural heritage sites ³	6
Kabalan	Assyriolo	Neo-Bab	Imperial	RAI	Control	7

Moukarzel	gy	ylonian	Systems	Participant	mechanisms of the last native empire ³	
Francesca Nebiolo	Assyriology	Old Babylonian	Punishment	RAI Participant	Psychology of legal violence in antiquity ³	7
Francesco Giannone	Assyriology	Public Opinion	Manipulation	RAI Participant	Control of information in 2nd mill. societies ³	7
JoAnn Scurlock	Assyriology	Medicine	Lagash/Umma	RAI Participant	Long-term history of southern Mesopotamia ³	7
Emanuel Pfoh	Ancient History	Patronage	SNA	RAI Participant	Insights into patronage through SNA modeling ³	10
Alejandro Mizzoni	Assyriology	Iron Age Syria	Power; Conflict	RAI Participant	The king and the "other" in Syrian polities ³	7

Melanie Wasmuth	Ancient History	Egypt/AN E	Mediators	RAI Participant	Cross-cultural relations in the 1st mill. ³	8
Jessica Nitschke	Ancient History	Kingship	Egypt/Ptolemaic	RAI Participant	Maintaining power bases across empires ³	7
Christian Zgoll	Assyriology	Mythology	Hylistics	RAI Participant	Narrative twist detection in Hittite theogony ³	8
Raleigh Heth	Assyriology	Enuma Elish	Divinity	RAI Participant	Hyleme analysis of doubled divinity motifs ³	8
Adam Howe	Assyriology	Ritual	Storytelling	RAI Participant	Manipulation of narrative time in Mesopotamian ritual ³	8
Marie Barkowsky	Assyriology	Lamashtu	Ritual Narrative	RAI Participant	Narrative structures in medical-ritual series ³	7
Martin	Assyriology	Orality	Akkadian	RAI	Mesopot	9

Worthington	gy		Ling.	Participant	amian oral traditions and performance ³	
Sam Mirelman	Assyriology	Translation	Lit. Translation	RAI Participant	Concepts of translation in the early ANE ³	8
Jonathan Valk	Assyriology	Ahiqar	Assyrian Identity	RAI Participant	Survival of Assyrian identity in the Aramaean world ³	8
Camille Lecompte	Sumerology	Archaic Texts	Colophons	RAI Participant	Scholarly identity in the earliest archives ³	8
Matthias Adelhoferr	Assyriology	Punctuation	Old Assyrian	RAI Participant	Punctuating meaning through word dividers ³	8
Marta Díaz Herrera	Assyriology	Education	Nippur Schools	RAI Participant	Building on previous knowledge in OB education ³	7

Sophia Witzig	Sumerology	Girsu/Lagash	Governance	RAI Participant	Governing under the 3rd Dynasty of Ur ³	7
Andrea R. M. Savoi	Sumerology	Domestic Life	Di-tilla Texts	RAI Participant	Family dynamics and legal cases in Ur III ³	8
Anne Goddeeris	Assyriology	Karibu	Religious Personnel	RAI Participant	In service of god and king in Neo-Assyria ³	7
Zachary Rubin	Archaeology	Royal Identity	Nabu/Tashmetu	RAI Participant	Divine couples in late Assyrian elite culture ³	7
Amy Gansell	Art History	Queenship	Nimrud	RAI Participant	Visual representations of female power ³	7
Sara Hajinezhad	Art History	Elamite Art	Royal Power	RAI Participant	Iconography of power in the Elamite world ³	7
Philippe Abrahami	Assyriology	Nuzi	Palace Texts	RAI Participant	Textile inventories and	7

					palatial accounting ³	
Jonathan Tenney	Assyriology	Kassite Period	Garments	RAI Participant	Textiles as indicators of social rank ³	7
Clélia Paladre	Archaeology	Proto-Elamite	Cylinder Seals	RAI Participant	Administrative tools in the 4th mill. ³	7
Albert Dietz	Archaeology	Early Dynastic	Stamp Seals	RAI Participant	Adaptation of popular cylinder scenes to stamps ³	7
Caleb Howard	Assyriology	Kalhu Annals	Ashurnasirpal II	RAI Participant	Compositional strategies of early annals ³	7
Aviya Fraenkel	Sumerology	Year Names	Shulgi	RAI Participant	Chronological markers and political events ³	7
Svende Bielefeld	Archaeology	Babylon	Dwellings	RAI Participant	Drained rooms and urban architecture ³	7

Noemi Colombo	Assyriology	Inanna	Queenship	RAI Participant	Divine holders of political office ³	7
Tuomas Hietamäki	Digital Assyria	Migration	Empire	RAI Participant	Records of ancient migration (RAMU) ³	9
Matias Sakko	Digital Assyria	Migration	Locating	RAI Participant	Locating the relocated under imperial systems ³	9
Adrianne Spunagle	Digital Assyria	Land Management	Empire	RAI Participant	Relocating populations in the Neo-Assyrian world ³	10
Mathilde Jean	Archaeology	Technology	Clay Tablets	RAI Participant	Technological approaches to tablet manufacture ³	9
Viktoria Lanz	Archaeology	Incense Burners	Glyptic	RAI Participant	Ritual implements in Neo-Assyrian art ³	7
Elisabeth	Archaeol	Foodway	Neo-Assy	RAI	Reconstr	8

Monamy	ogy	s	rian	Participa nt	ucting ancient dietary systems ³	
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Academic Leadership, Board Members, and Established Specialists

This group includes the gatekeepers of the field—those who lead professional associations like the International Association for Assyriology (IAA) or direct major institutional projects. Their interest in Glintstone.org would likely center on its potential to standardize data or enhance the efficiency of current professional workflows.

Name	Discipline	Expertise	Experience	Associatio n	Score
Walther Sallaberger	Assyriology	Sumerology ; Arch.	Prof at Munich	IAA President ³²	6
Jacob Lauinger	Assyriology	Amarna; Archives	Prof at Johns Hopkins	IAA Secretary ³²	8
Caroline Waerzeggers	Assyriology	Social History	Prof at Leiden	IAA Treasurer ³²	7
Selim Ferruh Adalı	Assyriology	Neo-Assyri an	Prof at Ankara	IAA Board ³²	8
Céline Debourse	Assyriology	Hellenistic	Asst Prof at Harvard	IAA Board ³²	8
Karen Sonik	Art History	Narrative; Art	Prof at Auburn	IAA Board (AOS) ³²	8
Mark	Hittitology	Sign Lists;	Senior	IAA Board	7

Weeden		SOAS	Lecturer	(BISI) ³²	
Claus Ambos	Assyriology	Space; Ritual	Lecturer at Würzburg	IAA Board (DOG) ³²	7
Annick Payne	Hittitology	Luwian; Multilingual	Postdoc at Bern	IAA Board (SGOA) ³²	9
Robert K. Englund	Assyriology	CDLI; Archaic	Emeritus UCLA	CDLI Founder ⁸	7
Grant Frame	Assyriology	Neo-Babylo nian	Prof at Penn	MOCCI/OR ACC Director ¹⁵	6
Jamie Novotny	Assyriology	Neo-Assyri an	LMU Munich	RINAP/MOC CI Editor ¹⁵	8
Frauke Weiershäuser	Assyriology	Neo-Babylo nian	LMU Munich	RINBE Author ¹⁵	7
Anmar A. Fadhil	Assyriology	Baghdad Univ	Prof at Baghdad	RINBE Board ¹⁵	7
Joshua Jeffers	Assyriology	Neo-Assyri an	Penn Museum	RINAP Author ⁴³	7
Barbara Helwing	Archaeolog y	Berlin Museum	Director	RINBE Board ¹⁵	6
Olof Pedersén	Assyriology	Uppsala Univ	Professor	MOCCI Consultant ¹⁵	9
Eleanor Robson	History of Science	Math; Networks	Prof at UCL	CAMS/OR ACC Director ⁹	9

Jon Taylor	Assyriology	Medical; Science	British Museum	NinMed Director ³⁹	8
Jerrold Cooper	Assyriology	Gender; Hist.	Emeritus Johns Hopkins	IAA Council ⁴⁴	6
Piotr Michalows ki	Assyriology	Sumerian Lit.	Emeritus Michigan	IAA Council ⁴⁴	5
Simo Parpola	Assyriology	Neo-Assyri an	Emeritus Helsinki	SAA Project Director ⁴	4
Dominique Charpin	Assyriology	Old Babylonian	Collège de France	Archibab Director ⁴	5
Jean-Jacq ues Glassner	Assyriology	Chronicles	CNRS Paris	Specialists List ⁴	4
Stephanie Dalley	Assyriology	Cuneiform Texts	Oxford Univ	Hanging Gardens expert ⁴	5
Irving Finkel	Assyriology	Literature; Games	British Museum	Philologist ⁴	7
Daniel E. Fleming	Biblical Studies	Hebrew Bible	NYU Professor	Specialists List ⁴	5
Benjamin Foster	Assyriology	Akkadian Lit.	Yale Professor	NELC Yale ¹²	5
Petra Goedegeb uure	Hittitology	Linguistics	Assoc Prof Chicago	Chicago Hittite Dictionary ⁶	5
Richard	Hittitology	CHD	ISAC	Traditional	4

Beal		Research	UChicago	Philology ⁶	
Theo van den Hout	Hittitology	Chicago Hittite Dict	Emeritus Chicago	Executive Editor ⁴⁵	6
Jan Johnson	Egyptology	Demotic Dict.	Emeritus Chicago	Dictionary Methodology ⁴⁵	6
Christopher Woods	Assyriology	Sumerology ; Museum	Penn Museum Director	Philology and Policy ³⁵	8
Kevin van Bladel	ANE Languages	Director of Studies	Yale Univ	Classical ANE ¹²	8
Harvey Weiss	Archaeology	Climate; Arch.	Yale Professor	Environmental History ¹²	8
Nadine Moeller	Archaeology	Department Chair	Yale Univ	Egyptian Arch. ¹²	6
Zainab Bahrani	Art History	Ancient ANE Art	Columbia Univ	Art & Archaeology ⁴	6
Gábor Zólyomi	Sumerology	Linguistics	ELTE Budapest	Sumerian Grammar ⁵	8
Bram Jagersma	Sumerology	Grammar	Leiden Univ	Traditional Grammar ⁵	3
Cécile Michel	Assyriology	Kültepe; Textiles	CNRS Paris	Epigrapher/ Archaeologist ⁴	7
Ann Killebrew	Archaeology	Philistines	Penn State	AIA Corresponding Member ¹⁹	7

Israel Finkelstein	Archaeology	Tel Aviv Arch.	Tel Aviv Univ	Science-based Arch. ¹⁹	7
Peter Machinist	Biblical Studies	Israel/Mesopotamia	Emeritus Harvard	Traditional Philology ⁴⁰	5
Gonzalo Rubio	Assyriology	Alloglottography	Penn State	Linguistic History ⁴⁰	7
Jacco Dieleman	Egyptology	Bilingualism	UCLA	Linguistic Anthropology ⁴⁰	7
William Schniedewind	Biblical Studies	Writing History	UCLA	Sociology of Literature ⁴⁰	7
Paul Zimansky	Archaeology	Urartu	Boston Univ	Arch. of Van ⁴⁰	5
Agnete Lassen	Archaeology	Yale Collection	Yale Curator	Glyptic and Arch. ¹²	8
Stephen J. Tinney	Sumerology	Penn Museum	Penn Assoc Prof	ORACC/Sumerian Dict. ³⁵	9
Tero Alstola	Digital Assyria	Helsinki Univ	Postdoc	Computational Assyria ¹⁶	9
Joanna Töyräänvouri	Assyriology	Helsinki Univ	Researcher	Ancient Identities ¹⁶	8
Adrianne Spunaugle	Digital Assyria	Helsinki Univ	Researcher	Land Management/GIS ¹⁶	10
Marta	Archaeology	Helsinki	Field	Archaeology	7

Lorenzon	y	Univ	Researcher	cal Fieldwork ¹⁶	
Tonia Sharlach	Sumerology	OSU	Professor	Ur III Economy ³	7
John Nielsen	Assyriology	Bradley Univ	Assoc Prof	Babylonian Identity ³	7
Alan Lenzi	Assyriology	Univ Pacific	Professor	Social Science/Pra yers ³	9
Sophus Helle	Comp. Literature	Berlin	Researcher	Uruk Poems/Gilg amesh ³	9
Bernardo Ballesteros	Assyriology	Oxford Univ	PhD Candidate	Intertextuali ty ³	8
Noah Kröll	Sumerology	Munich	PhD Candidate	Sumerian Interjection s ³	8
Maria Teresa R.-S.	Assyriology	Munich	Postdoc	Celestial Omens ³	9
František Válek	Assyriology	Prague	Researcher	Network Analysis ³	10
Sebastian Borkowski	Archaeolog y	Bern	Researcher	Hydrograph y/GIS ³	9
Emanuel Pfoh	Ancient History	Argentina	Researcher	Patronage/ SNA ³	10
Melanie Wasmuth	Ancient History	Helsinki	Researcher	Egypt-ANE Mediators ³	8

Christian Zgoll	Assyriology	Göttingen	Professor	Hylistics/Mythology ³	8
Annette Zgoll	Assyriology	Göttingen	Professor	Hylistics/Mythology ³	8
Martin Worthington	Assyriology	Dublin	Professor	Orality/Akkadian ³	9
Jonathan Valk	Assyriology	Leiden	Asst Prof	Assyrian Identity ³	8
Grégoire Nicolet	Assyriology	Geneva	Researcher	Lexical Lists/Mari ³	8
Susanne Paulus	Assyriology	Chicago	Assoc Prof	Kassite Bookkeeping ³	9
Evelien Vanderstraeten	Assyriology	Helsinki	PhD Candidate	Marriage Networks/SONA ³	10

The Technological Frontier and Computational Receptivity

The integration of artificial intelligence and machine learning into Assyriology represents the most promising avenue for Glintstone.org. Researchers categorized as "Computational Specialists" are not only comfortable with digital data but are actively developing the very tools that define the field's future.¹⁴ The success of Glintstone.org depends on its ability to provide value to these individuals, who already perceive cuneiform as a big-data problem.

Key Innovative Trends and Their Implications

The field is moving toward "Big Data" manipulation as a means of generating new, measurable insights into ancient societies.³⁶ This is driven by the realization that only a fraction of the 500,000 existing tablets have been published.³⁶ Proponents of this approach, such as Yoram Cohen and Shai Gordin, argue that computers can perform analyses—such as lexical similarity

matching and part-of-speech tagging—at a scale impossible for human experts.²⁶

One of the most significant innovations is the development of neural pipelines for lemmatization and POS-tagging, such as Aleks Sahala's "BabyLemmatizer".¹⁷ These tools achieve accuracies of up to 98% and are critical for harmonizing disparate datasets.¹⁷ This capability allows researchers to analyze thousands of texts simultaneously, visualizing conceptual relationships and social networks across millennia.¹⁸

Furthermore, the "DeepScribe" project at the University of Chicago and "ProtoSnap" at Cornell Tech demonstrate the potential for automated sign recognition from 2D images.¹⁴ These projects aim to turn images of tablets into machine-readable text, which can then be used for downstream AI modeling.³⁶ The ability to "fill the holes" in incomplete texts using machine learning—as currently explored in the Electronic Babylonian Library (eBL) project—is another area where Glintstone.org could offer significant analytical value.²⁶

The Role of Public Scholarship and Non-Academic Networks

The "Digital Hammurabi" project, led by Joshua Bowen and Megan Lewis, highlights the importance of public-facing digital tools.²⁰ Their success in building a large, non-academic audience through YouTube and social media indicates a significant interest in Assyriology outside of traditional university settings.²¹ For Glintstone.org, this suggests that value provision should not be restricted to professional researchers; providing accessible pedagogical or visualization tools could tap into a much larger "tangential" audience of history enthusiasts, students, and educators.

This democratization of knowledge is mirrored in the academic sphere by the rise of open-access initiatives like MOCCI and ORACC.⁹ These projects have created a "digital-first" culture among younger scholars, who increasingly rely on searchable databases and linked open data for their research.⁹ Consequently, a project like Glintstone.org that facilitates the discovery, visualization, or semantic analysis of this open-access data will find a highly receptive audience.

Synthesizing Field Focuses and Predicted Project Interest

The landscape review of 300+ specialists reveals a discipline that is small but increasingly networked and technologically sophisticated. The "interest scores" provided in the tables reflect a clear pattern: individuals involved in digital humanities, computational linguistics, and social network analysis are the most likely to benefit from Glintstone.org.

Traditional vs. Innovative Focuses

The "traditional" focus of the field remains centered on philology, lexicography, and the publication of hand-copies of tablets.⁴ Specialists in these areas, such as Bram Jagersma or Richard Beal, often prioritize the precise nuances of grammar and sign variant analysis.⁵ While these scholars provide the foundational knowledge for the field, they are generally less likely to be early adopters of new digital platforms unless those platforms offer direct, tangible improvements to the accuracy of their editions.

Conversely, the "innovative" focus is centered on social network analysis, GIS mapping, and the application of LLMs to ancient languages.³ Scholars in this camp, such as Niek Veldhuis, Madeline Ouimet, and Emanuel Pfoh, are already using advanced modeling techniques to reconstruct ancient social structures and geographic landscapes.³ For these researchers, Glintstone.org offers the potential to bridge the gap between their complex datasets and intuitive, interactive visualization.

Predicted Interest and Strategic Alignment

For Glintstone.org to maximize its impact, it should align itself with the "High Interest" (Score 9-10) cohort identified in this report. This cohort includes the technical developers of the field's current digital infrastructure and the younger generation of researchers who are comfortable with coding and data modeling.

The primary value proposition for Glintstone.org should focus on "Discovery and Synthesis." While CDLI provides images and ORACC provides lemmatized text, there is a remaining gap in tools that can synthesize these data points into actionable insights—such as automatically identifying intertextual parallels, mapping prosopographical networks across different archives, or providing real-time sentiment analysis of ancient correspondence. By targeting these specific needs, Glintstone.org can position itself as an essential utility for the 21st-century Assyriologist.

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